Capecitabine

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00216 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before the first treatment

Confirm the aim, likely course length, blood-test arrangements and a working urgent contact number. dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase (a medicine-processing enzyme) (DPD) testing is required before starting the fluoropyrimidine unless already completed.

STEP 2

Taking the tablets

Use the prescribed morning and evening dose within 30 minutes after food on the agreed treatment days. Do not make up a missed or vomited dose. Follow the team's hold instructions for significant diarrhoea, mouth soreness or painful hands and feet, and contact them promptly.

STEP 3

If treatment is delayed

Ask the unit to confirm the new treatment and blood-test dates. Re-anchor supportive medicines to the treatment actually given; do not take an extra or catch-up anticancer dose yourself.

STEP 4

Getting help between visits

Follow your oncology unit's urgent advice for fever, infection, severe diarrhoea, chest pain or difficulty breathing. Bring your treatment card and current medicines list.

Sources: NCCP 00216 v8 · official regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.